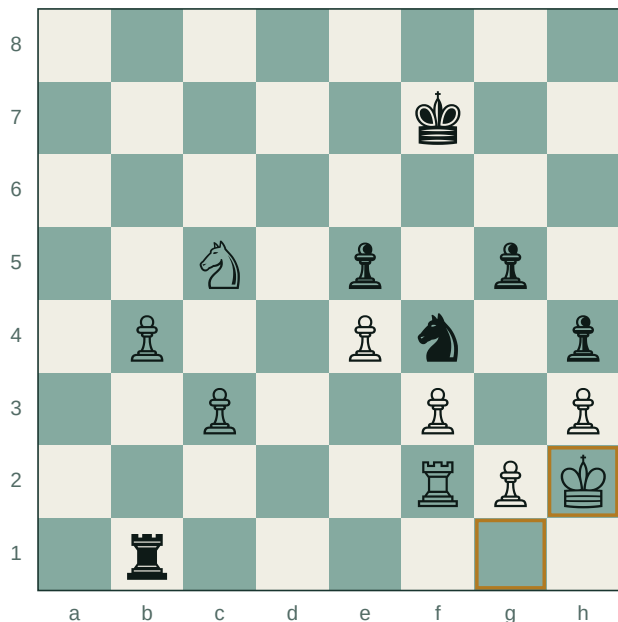


Quiet tactical moves: Black, move 37

Quiet tactical moves

Black to move



Previous move: 37.Kh2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37...Nh5 38. g3 hxg3+ 39. Kg2 gxf2

37...Nh5 The knight moves from f4 to h5. Recorded reply: **38.g3**.

38...hxg3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From g3 it attacks king on h2 and rook on f2. Recorded reply: **39.Kg2**.

39...gxf2 The pawn captures the rook on f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: rook on f2. Check for tactical protection.